
FREE GUIDE

CAN YOU REALLY BUILD MUSCLE & LOSE FAT AT THE SAME TIME?

The No-BS Body Recomposition Blueprint
For Any Experience Level

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WELCOME

LET'S CUT THE BS.

You've probably heard it a thousand times:

"You can't build muscle and lose fat at the same time."

That's not true. And I'm going to show you exactly how it works — no fluff, no bro-science, just the framework that actually gets results.

This guide breaks down the real science of body recomposition into simple, actionable steps you can start using today. Whether you're a complete beginner or you've been training for years, this will change how you approach your physique.

Let's get into it.

WHAT YOU'LL LEARN:

- Why most people fail at recomposition
- The 4 pillars of building muscle while losing fat
- A sample daily nutrition + training structure
- Quick-win actions you can implement today
- Your next step to accelerate results

WHY MOST PEOPLE FAIL.

MYTH #1

"You need to bulk first, then cut."

This outdated approach leads to months of unnecessary fat gain. Recomposition lets you do both simultaneously — especially if you're under-trained or carrying extra body fat.

MYTH #2

"You can't gain muscle in a calorie deficit."

Wrong. Your body can use stored fat as fuel while building new tissue — if protein is high enough and training stimulus is right.

MYTH #3

"You need to spend hours in the gym."

Quality beats quantity. 3-5 well-structured sessions per week with progressive overload is all you need. More isn't always better.

MYTH #4

"Supplements are the missing piece."

No supplement replaces a solid nutrition and training foundation. Get the basics locked in first — that's where 95% of results come from.

THE REAL REASON PEOPLE FAIL?

They overcomplicate it. This guide keeps it simple.

THE 4-PILLAR FRAMEWORK.

Body recomposition isn't magic — it's the result of nailing these four things consistently. Miss one, and progress stalls.

01

CALORIE MANAGEMENT

Eat at maintenance or a slight deficit (100-300 cal below). This creates the environment for fat loss without starving your muscles of fuel.

02

HIGH PROTEIN INTAKE

Aim for 1.6-2.2g per kg of bodyweight daily. Protein is the building block — without enough, recomposition doesn't happen.

03

PROGRESSIVE RESISTANCE TRAINING

Train 3-5x per week with compound lifts. Focus on getting stronger over time — progressive overload is the #1 driver of muscle growth.

04

RECOVERY & CONSISTENCY

Sleep 7-9 hours. Manage stress. Show up week after week. The best program is the one you can stick to for months, not days.

KEY TAKEAWAY

You don't need perfection. You need to be consistent with these 4 pillars 80-90% of the time. That's where the magic happens.

YOUR DAILY STRUCTURE.

Here's what a typical recomposition day looks like. This isn't a rigid meal plan — it's a framework you adapt to your life.

7:00 AM

MORNING

High-protein breakfast (40-50g protein)

Black coffee or green tea

10-min walk or light mobility

12:00 PM

MIDDAY

Balanced lunch (protein + complex carbs + veggies)

Stay hydrated — aim for 2-3L water by now

Short walk if possible (NEAT boost)

4:00 PM

TRAINING

45-60 min resistance training session

Compound lifts first, isolation work after

Track weights and reps for progressive overload

7:00 PM

EVENING

Post-workout meal (protein + carbs to refuel)

Wind down — reduce screen time

Aim for 7-9 hours quality sleep

REMEMBER

This is a template, not a rulebook. Adjust meal timing around YOUR schedule. The key is hitting your protein and calorie targets consistently.

YOUR ACTION CHECKLIST.

Stop overthinking. Start here. These are the non-negotiables that drive 90% of your results.

☐

Eat 1.6-2.2g protein per kg of bodyweight daily

☐

Train with weights 3-5x per week

☐

Focus on compound lifts (squat, bench, deadlift, rows, press)

☐

Progressive overload — add weight or reps each week

☐

Eat at maintenance or slight deficit (100-300 cal below)

☐

Sleep 7-9 hours every single night

☐

Drink 2-3 litres of water daily

☐

Walk 8,000-10,000 steps per day (NEAT)

☐

Track your workouts — what gets measured gets managed

☐

Stay consistent for at least 8-12 weeks before judging results

PROTEIN: YOUR #1 TOOL.

If there's one thing you take from this guide, let it be this: protein is the single most important nutritional factor for body recomposition. Here's why and how much you actually need.

WHY PROTEIN MATTERS

- Builds and repairs muscle tissue after training
- Has the highest thermic effect (burns calories just digesting it)
- Keeps you fuller for longer — reduces cravings
- Preserves muscle mass during a calorie deficit
- Supports recovery between sessions

HOW MUCH DO YOU NEED?

BEGINNER (new to lifting)
1.6g per kg bodyweight e.g. 80kg = 128g protein/day
INTERMEDIATE (1-3 years training)
1.8-2.0g per kg bodyweight e.g. 80kg = 144-160g protein/day
ADVANCED (3+ years, lean)
2.0-2.2g per kg bodyweight e.g. 80kg = 160-176g protein/day

PRO TIP

Spread protein across 3-5 meals per day (30-50g per meal). This maximises muscle protein synthesis throughout the day rather than dumping it all in one sitting.

CALORIE MANAGEMENT.

You don't need to starve yourself. You need to be strategic. Here's how to set your calories for recomposition without losing your mind (or your muscle).

STEP 1: FIND YOUR MAINTENANCE

Bodyweight (kg) x 28-32 = estimated maintenance calories

Example: 80kg x 30 = 2,400 calories/day

This is your starting point. Track for 2 weeks and adjust based on scale + mirror.

STEP 2: SET YOUR DEFICIT

FOR RECOMPOSITION (not aggressive fat loss):

- Beginners/overweight: 200-300 cal deficit
- Intermediate: 100-200 cal deficit (or maintenance)
- Advanced/lean: Eat at maintenance, rely on training stimulus

Smaller deficit = more muscle preserved = better recomp results

STEP 3: MACRO SPLIT

PROTEIN

30-35%

of total calories

CARBS

35-40%

fuel for training

FATS

25-30%

hormones & health

KEY POINT

Don't obsess over exact percentages. Hit your protein target first, then fill the rest with carbs and fats based on preference. Consistency > perfection.

CALORIE CYCLING.

Calorie cycling means eating more on training days and less on rest days. This fuels performance when you need it and maximises fat loss when you don't.

HOW IT WORKS

TRAINING DAYS

HIGHER CALORIES

- Maintenance or +100-200 cals
- Higher carbs (fuel training)
- Protein stays the same
- Fats moderate
- Eat majority of carbs around training

REST DAYS

LOWER CALORIES

- 200-400 cal below maintenance
- Lower carbs (less fuel needed)
- Protein stays the same
- Slightly higher fats
- Focus on whole foods + veggies

EXAMPLE (80KG MALE)

Training days (4x/week): 2,500 cals | 200g protein | 280g carbs | 70g fat
Rest days (3x/week): 2,100 cals | 200g protein | 150g carbs | 80g fat

Weekly average: ~2,330 cals/day (slight deficit for recomp)

IS THIS NECESSARY?

No. Calorie cycling is an optimisation tool, not a requirement. If hitting consistent daily calories is hard enough, just stick to a flat intake. Add cycling later when basics are locked in.

YOUR TRAINING SPLIT.

For recomposition, an Upper/Lower split (4 days) is one of the best options. It hits every muscle twice per week with enough recovery time built in.

WEEKLY LAYOUT

MON	UPPER BODY A
TUE	LOWER BODY A
WED	REST / CARDIO
THU	UPPER BODY B
FRI	LOWER BODY B
SAT	REST / ACTIVE RECOVERY
SUN	REST

WHY THIS WORKS

- Each muscle trained 2x per week (optimal frequency for growth)
- 48-72 hours recovery between same muscle groups
- 4 sessions = manageable for busy schedules
- A/B variation prevents plateaus and boredom
- Enough volume without overtraining

FLEXIBILITY

Can only train 3 days? Do Upper/Lower/Full Body. The exact days don't matter — just keep the pattern consistent and never skip legs.

UPPER BODY DAY.

Here's a sample upper body session. Focus on controlled reps, full range of motion, and progressive overload week to week.

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
Barbell Bench Press	4	6-8	3 min
Barbell Row	4	6-8	3 min
Overhead Press	3	8-10	2 min
Lat Pulldown	3	10-12	90s
Incline DB Press	3	10-12	90s
Face Pulls	3	15-20	60s
Bicep Curls	2	12-15	60s
Tricep Pushdowns	2	12-15	60s

TRAINING NOTES

Start with compound movements when you're freshest. Leave 1-2 reps in reserve on most sets (RPE 7-8). Only go to failure on isolation exercises. Log every session.

LOWER BODY DAY.

Legs are where the real growth happens. These compound movements recruit the most muscle fibres and trigger the biggest hormonal response.

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST
Barbell Back Squat	4	6-8	3 min
Romanian Deadlift	4	8-10	2.5 min
Leg Press	3	10-12	2 min
Walking Lunges	3	12/leg	90s
Leg Curl	3	10-12	90s
Leg Extension	3	12-15	60s
Standing Calf Raise	4	12-15	60s

TRAINING NOTES

Warm up with 2-3 lighter sets before your working weight on squats. Keep your core braced on all lifts. If mobility limits depth, work on ankle and hip flexibility.

CARDIO FOR RECOMP.

Cardio isn't the enemy — but doing too much of the wrong type will eat into your recovery and muscle gains. Here's how to use it strategically.

THE HIERARCHY

01

NEAT (Non-Exercise Activity)

Walking, taking stairs, standing desk, fidgeting. This burns MORE calories than formal cardio for most people. Aim for 8-10k steps daily.

02

LISS (Low Intensity Steady State)

Brisk walking, easy cycling, swimming. 20-40 minutes, 2-3x per week. Low fatigue, easy to recover from, burns fat without impacting lifting.

03

HIIT (High Intensity Interval Training)

Sprints, bike intervals, battle ropes. 15-20 minutes max, 1-2x per week. Effective but taxing — don't overdo it or your lifting will suffer.

MY RECOMMENDATION

- Prioritise NEAT above everything (daily steps)
- Add 2-3 LISS sessions per week (post-workout or off days)
- Use HIIT sparingly — 1x per week max during recomp
- Never do HIIT before a leg day
- If you're recovering well and fat loss stalls, add more LISS first
- Cardio should SUPPORT your lifting, not compete with it

REALITY CHECK

You cannot out-cardio a bad diet. If fat loss is the goal, nutrition does 80% of the work. Cardio is the accelerator, not the engine.

SLEEP & RECOVERY.

You don't grow in the gym — you grow while you sleep. Recovery is where the magic happens. Ignore it and you'll spin your wheels no matter how hard you train.

WHY SLEEP IS NON-NEGOTIABLE

- Growth hormone peaks during deep sleep — this drives muscle repair
- Poor sleep increases cortisol (stress hormone that promotes fat storage)
- Sleep deprivation tanks testosterone by up to 15% in one week
- Hunger hormones (ghrelin) spike when you're under-slept — hello cravings
- Recovery between sessions drops — performance suffers, injury risk rises

YOUR SLEEP PROTOCOL

7-9 HOURS

Minimum. Non-negotiable. Schedule it like a training session.

CONSISTENT TIMES

Same bedtime and wake time daily — even weekends.

COOL & DARK

Room temp 16-19°C. Blackout curtains. No blue light 1hr before bed.

NO CAFFEINE AFTER 2PM

Caffeine has a 6-hour half-life. That 4pm coffee is still in your system at 10pm.

WIND DOWN ROUTINE

Read, stretch, meditate. Signal to your brain it's time to shut off.

TRACKING PROGRESS.

The scale lies. Here's how to actually measure whether your body recomposition is working — and when to adjust.

THE 5 METRICS THAT MATTER

01

PROGRESS PHOTOS

Take front, side, and back photos every 2 weeks. Same lighting, same time of day. This is your #1 tool.

02

BODY MEASUREMENTS

Chest, waist, hips, arms, thighs. Measure weekly. Waist going down + arms going up = recomp working.

03

STRENGTH IN THE GYM

Are your lifts going up? If you're getting stronger, you're building muscle. Track every session.

04

WEEKLY WEIGHT AVERAGE

Weigh daily, take the weekly average. Ignore daily fluctuations — trends over 3-4 weeks matter.

05

HOW YOU FEEL & LOOK

Energy levels, sleep quality, how clothes fit. These subjective markers matter more than you think.

PATIENCE

Give it 8-12 weeks before making major changes. Recomposition is slower than pure cutting or bulking — but the results are worth the wait.

COMMON MISTAKES.

These are the mistakes I see 90% of people make when trying to recomp. Avoid these and you're already ahead of the pack.



CUTTING TOO AGGRESSIVELY

A huge deficit kills muscle. You'll lose weight but look worse. Recomp needs patience, not starvation.



SKIPPING PROTEIN TARGETS

If you're not hitting 1.6-2.2g/kg daily, you're leaving muscle on the table. This is the #1 priority.



NO PROGRESSIVE OVERLOAD

Doing the same weight every week = no growth stimulus. You MUST be adding reps or weight over time.



TOO MUCH CARDIO

Excessive cardio eats into recovery and muscle. Prioritise lifting and use cardio as a tool, not the main event.



IGNORING SLEEP

6 hours isn't enough. Your hormones, recovery, and hunger all suffer. This alone can stall progress.



PROGRAM HOPPING

Switching programs every 2 weeks means you never adapt. Pick one and run it for 8-12 weeks minimum.



OBSESSING OVER THE SCALE

Your weight can stay the same while your body transforms. Use photos, measurements, and strength as markers.

SUPPLEMENTS WORTH TAKING.

Supplements are the icing, not the cake. Get your training, nutrition, and sleep dialled in first. Then — and only then — consider these evidence-based options.

TIER 1: ACTUALLY WORTH IT

CREATINE MONOHYDRATE

5g daily. Most researched supplement in history. Improves strength, power output, and muscle hydration. Cheap and effective.

PROTEIN POWDER

Whey or plant-based. Use to hit your daily protein target when whole food isn't convenient. Not magic — just food in powder form.

CAFFEINE

200-400mg pre-workout. Improves focus, strength, and endurance. Coffee works fine — you don't need a fancy pre-workout.

TIER 2: NICE TO HAVE

VITAMIN D3

2000-5000 IU daily if you don't get regular sun. Supports testosterone, mood, and immune function.

OMEGA-3 (FISH OIL)

2-3g EPA/DHA daily. Reduces inflammation, supports joint health and recovery.

MAGNESIUM

200-400mg before bed. Improves sleep quality and muscle relaxation.

SKIP THESE

BCAAs (waste of money if you eat enough protein), fat burners (glorified caffeine pills), testosterone boosters (don't work). Save your cash.

MINDSET & DISCIPLINE.

Motivation gets you started. Discipline keeps you going. Here's the mental framework that separates people who transform from people who quit after 3 weeks.

THE 5 MINDSET SHIFTS

01

IDENTITY OVER GOALS

Don't say 'I want to get fit.' Say 'I am someone who trains.' When fitness becomes who you ARE, not just what you do, consistency becomes automatic.

02

PROGRESS OVER PERFECTION

A bad workout is better than no workout. An 80% nutrition day beats a 0% day. Stop waiting for perfect conditions — they don't exist.

03

SYSTEMS OVER WILLPOWER

Willpower runs out. Systems don't. Meal prep on Sundays. Gym bag packed the night before. Remove decisions from the equation.

04

LONG GAME THINKING

You didn't get out of shape in 4 weeks. You won't transform in 4 weeks either. Think in 6-month blocks, not 6-day sprints.

05

COMPARISON IS POISON

The only person you're competing with is yesterday's version of you. Social media shows highlight reels, not the years of work behind them.

"The pain of discipline weighs ounces.
The pain of regret weighs tons."

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS.

The questions I get asked most. If yours isn't here, reach out — I'm always happy to help.

Can I really build muscle and lose fat at the same time?

Yes — especially if you're a beginner, returning after a break, or carrying extra body fat. The more trained and lean you are, the slower it gets, but it's still possible with the right approach.

How long does body recomposition take?

Expect visible changes in 8-12 weeks if you're consistent. It's slower than a hard cut or bulk, but the results are more sustainable and you look better throughout the process.

Do I need to track calories?

Not necessarily. Tracking helps with awareness, but you can also use portion control methods (palm-sized protein, fist-sized carbs, thumb-sized fats). The key is consistency and hitting protein targets.

Should I do cardio on rest days?

Light cardio (walking, easy cycling) is fine and even beneficial for recovery. Avoid intense cardio on rest days — save your energy for lifting sessions.

MORE QUESTIONS.

What if I'm skinny fat — should I bulk or cut first?

Neither. Recomp is literally made for you. Eat at maintenance, train hard, hit protein targets. You'll lose fat and build muscle simultaneously. Give it 12 weeks.

How important is meal timing?

It matters less than you think. Total daily intake and protein distribution (3-5 meals) matter most. That said, eating protein within 2 hours of training is a smart move.

Can I drink alcohol and still recomp?

Occasionally, yes. Regularly, no. Alcohol impairs recovery, disrupts sleep, and adds empty calories. A few drinks on the weekend won't ruin you — but daily drinking will stall progress.

What if I miss a workout?

One missed session changes nothing. Two missed weeks changes everything. If you miss a day, just pick up where you left off. Don't try to 'make up' for it with double sessions.

I'm not seeing results after 4 weeks — what's wrong?

Probably nothing. 4 weeks is too early to judge recomp. Are you stronger? Are you consistent? If yes, keep going. Real visible changes take 8-12 weeks minimum.

YOUR 8-WEEK TIMELINE.

Here's what to expect week by week. Recomposition is a marathon, not a sprint. Trust the process and let the results compound.

WEEK 1-2

FOUNDATION

Build habits. Learn the lifts. Dial in nutrition tracking. Don't expect visible changes yet — you're laying groundwork.

WEEK 3-4

ADAPTATION

Strength starts increasing. Muscles feel fuller after training. You're finding your groove with meal prep and consistency.

WEEK 5-6

MOMENTUM

Clothes fit differently. Lifts are noticeably stronger. Energy improves. Others might start commenting on changes.

WEEK 7-8

RESULTS

Visible changes in the mirror. Measurements shifting. Strength PRs. This is where it clicks and you see the payoff.

AFTER 8 WEEKS

Reassess. Take new photos, measurements, and compare strength. If recomp is working, keep going. If fat loss has stalled, slightly reduce calories. If strength has plateaued, increase volume or deload.

MEAL PREP MADE SIMPLE.

Meal prep isn't about eating boring chicken and rice 6 times a day. It's about removing decision fatigue so you hit your targets without thinking.

THE SUNDAY SYSTEM

01

PICK 2-3 PROTEINS

Cook in bulk: chicken thighs, lean mince, salmon. Enough for 4-5 days.

02

BATCH YOUR CARBS

Rice, potatoes, pasta — cook a big pot. Portion into containers.

03

PREP YOUR VEGGIES

Wash, chop, roast. Broccoli, peppers, spinach, sweet potato.

04

PORTION & STORE

Divide into containers. Label if needed. Fridge for 3 days, freeze the rest.

05

SNACKS READY

Greek yoghurt, protein bars, boiled eggs, fruit. Grab-and-go options.

TIME INVESTMENT

60-90 minutes on a Sunday saves you 5+ hours of cooking and decision-making during the week. That's the best ROI you'll ever get.

HIGH PROTEIN MEAL IDEAS.

Hitting your protein target doesn't have to be boring. Here are quick, easy meals that pack 30-50g protein each — no chef skills required.

BREAKFAST OPTIONS

4 eggs + 2 toast + avocado	~35g protein
Greek yoghurt + protein granola + berries	~40g protein
Protein oats (oats + whey + banana + PB)	~45g protein

LUNCH / DINNER OPTIONS

Chicken thigh + rice + roasted veg	~45g protein
Lean beef mince stir fry + noodles	~40g protein
Salmon fillet + sweet potato + greens	~38g protein
Turkey meatballs + pasta + tomato sauce	~42g protein
Tuna wrap + salad + hummus	~35g protein

SNACK OPTIONS

Protein shake + banana	~30g protein
Cottage cheese + fruit	~25g protein
2 boiled eggs + rice cakes	~15g protein

PROGRESSIVE OVERLOAD.

Progressive overload is the #1 driver of muscle growth. Without it, your body has no reason to adapt. Here's how to apply it properly.

WHAT IS IT?

Gradually increasing the demands placed on your muscles over time. More weight, more reps, more sets, or better form — any of these count as progression.

5 WAYS TO PROGRESSIVELY OVERLOAD

01

ADD WEIGHT

The most obvious. Add 1-2.5kg when you hit the top of your rep range on all sets.

02

ADD REPS

Can't add weight yet? Go from 8 reps to 9, then 10. Then add weight and drop back to 8.

03

ADD SETS

Increase total volume over a training block. Go from 3 sets to 4 on key lifts.

04

IMPROVE FORM

Slower eccentrics, fuller range of motion, better mind-muscle connection. Same weight, harder stimulus.

05

REDUCE REST

Same work in less time = higher density. Use sparingly — rest matters for strength.

THE GOLDEN RULE

Log every workout. If you can't tell me what you lifted last week, you can't beat it this week. A training log is your most powerful tool.

DELOAD WEEKS.

Training hard every single week without a break is a recipe for burnout, injury, and stalled progress. Deloads are strategic recovery — not laziness.

WHAT IS A DELOAD?

A planned week of reduced training intensity or volume. You still train — but lighter. This allows your joints, nervous system, and muscles to fully recover and come back stronger.

WHEN TO DELOAD

- Every 4-6 weeks of hard training
- When strength starts declining for 2+ sessions
- When you feel constantly fatigued or unmotivated
- When joints are aching more than usual
- After completing a training block or program

HOW TO DELOAD

OPTION A: REDUCE WEIGHT

Keep sets and reps the same, drop weight to 50-60% of your working weight.

OPTION B: REDUCE VOLUME

Keep weight the same, cut sets in half (e.g. 4 sets becomes 2).

OPTION C: REDUCE FREQUENCY

Train 2x instead of 4x that week. Full body sessions only.

MINDSET SHIFT

A deload isn't a week off. It's an investment in your next 4-6 weeks of progress. The best lifters in the world deload religiously. You should too.

STRESS & CORTISOL.

Stress is the silent gains killer. High cortisol promotes fat storage (especially around the midsection), impairs recovery, and tanks your motivation. Here's how to manage it.

WHAT CORTISOL DOES TO YOUR BODY

- Increases fat storage — especially visceral belly fat
- Breaks down muscle tissue for energy (catabolic)
- Disrupts sleep quality and duration
- Increases appetite and cravings for junk food
- Weakens immune system and slows recovery

HOW TO LOWER CORTISOL

SLEEP 7-9 HOURS

The single biggest cortisol reducer. Non-negotiable.

LIMIT CAFFEINE AFTER 12PM

Caffeine spikes cortisol. Keep it to mornings only.

WALK DAILY

20-30 min walks lower cortisol significantly. Nature walks even more so.

BREATHWORK

5 minutes of deep breathing (box breathing: 4-4-4-4) before bed.

REDUCE TRAINING VOLUME IF NEEDED

More isn't always better. If you're chronically stressed, train 3x instead of 5x.

SET BOUNDARIES

Say no more. Reduce screen time. Protect your energy.

ALCOHOL & SOCIAL LIFE.

You don't have to become a hermit to get results. But you do need to understand how alcohol affects your body and make informed choices.

HOW ALCOHOL HURTS YOUR PROGRESS

- Reduces muscle protein synthesis by up to 37%
- Disrupts sleep architecture (less deep sleep = less recovery)
- Adds empty calories (a night out can easily be 1,500+ cals)
- Increases estrogen and lowers testosterone
- Dehydrates you — impairs next-day performance
- Leads to poor food choices (drunk munchies are real)

THE DAMAGE CONTROL PLAYBOOK

LIMIT TO 1-2 NIGHTS/MONTH

Not per week. Once you're seeing results, the occasional night won't derail you.

CHOOSE LOWER-CAL OPTIONS

Spirits + zero-cal mixer > beer > cocktails. Vodka soda = ~100 cals. Pint of beer = 200-250.

EAT PROTEIN BEFORE GOING OUT

A high-protein meal beforehand reduces drunk eating and protects muscle.

HYDRATE BETWEEN DRINKS

One glass of water per alcoholic drink. You'll drink less and feel better tomorrow.

TRAIN BEFORE, NOT AFTER

Get your session in earlier that day. Don't try to train hungover — it's pointless.

BREAKING PLATEAUS.

Everyone hits a wall eventually. The difference between people who transform and people who quit is knowing how to break through it. Here's your troubleshooting guide.

FAT LOSS STALLED?

- Reduce calories by another 100-200 (not more)
- Add 1-2 extra LISS sessions per week
- Increase daily steps by 2,000
- Check for hidden calories (sauces, oils, drinks)
- Are you actually tracking accurately? Re-weigh portions
- Consider a diet break (2 weeks at maintenance) then resume

STRENGTH STALLED?

- Take a deload week (reduce volume 50%)
- Increase calories slightly (especially carbs pre-workout)
- Are you sleeping enough? Check recovery basics
- Change rep ranges (if doing 6-8, try 8-12 for 4 weeks)
- Add a variation (swap flat bench for incline, etc.)
- Check form — are you actually using full ROM?

MOTIVATION STALLED?

- Look at your progress photos from week 1
- Remember: motivation follows action, not the other way around
- Change your environment (new gym, new playlist, training partner)
- Set a short-term challenge (beat a PR this week)
- Revisit your WHY — why did you start this?
- Accept that some days are just showing up. That's enough.

REMEMBER

Plateaus are normal. They mean your body has adapted — which is actually a sign of progress. Adjust, don't quit.

RECOMP BY EXPERIENCE LEVEL.

Not everyone should approach recomposition the same way. Your training age determines how aggressive you can be and what results to expect.

BEGINNER (0-1 YEAR TRAINING)

You have the BEST recomp potential. Newbie gains are real — you can build muscle and lose fat rapidly at the same time.

- Calorie deficit: 200-400 cal below maintenance
- Protein: 1.6-2.0g/kg
- Training: Full body 3x or Upper/Lower 4x
- Expected results: Visible changes in 6-8 weeks
- Muscle gain potential: 4-6kg in first year

INTERMEDIATE (1-3 YEARS TRAINING)

Recomp still works but it's slower. You need to be more precise with nutrition and training programming.

- Calorie deficit: 100-200 cal or maintenance
- Protein: 1.8-2.2g/kg
- Training: Upper/Lower or PPL, 4-5x per week
- Expected results: Noticeable changes in 10-12 weeks
- Muscle gain potential: 2-4kg per year

ADVANCED (3+ YEARS TRAINING)

Recomp is slow but still possible. Consider dedicated bulk/cut cycles if you want faster visual changes.

- Calories: At maintenance (calorie cycling helps)
- Protein: 2.0-2.4g/kg
- Training: High volume, periodised programming
- Expected results: Subtle changes over 12-16+ weeks
- Muscle gain potential: 1-2kg per year

BOTTOM LINE

Wherever you are, recomp works. The less trained you are, the faster you'll see results. Be patient and trust the data.

WEEKLY PLANNING.

Use this template every Sunday to set yourself up for a winning week. 10 minutes of planning saves hours of scrambling and missed targets.

YOUR SUNDAY CHECKLIST

SCHEDULE YOUR TRAINING

☐

Block out your 4 sessions in your calendar. Treat them like meetings you can't cancel.

MEAL PREP

☐

Cook protein + carbs in bulk. Portion into containers. Prep snacks.

SET YOUR WEEKLY TARGETS

☐

What weight are you hitting on key lifts? What's your step goal? Write it down.

CHECK LAST WEEK'S DATA

☐

Review your training log. Did you progress? If not, why? Adjust this week.

WEIGH & PHOTOGRAPH

☐

Morning weight (add to weekly average). Progress photo every 2 weeks.

RESTOCK ESSENTIALS

☐

Protein powder, creatine, groceries. Don't let running out derail your week.

SET ONE FOCUS GOAL

☐

Pick ONE thing to improve this week. Better sleep? More steps? Heavier squats?

THE RULE

If it's not planned, it won't happen. Winners don't wing it — they prepare. Make Sunday planning a non-negotiable habit.

WORDS TO TRAIN BY.

Save this page. Come back to it on the days you don't feel like showing up. These reminders have kept me and my clients on track when motivation disappears.

"You don't have to be extreme. You just have to be consistent."

"The body achieves what the mind believes."

"Discipline is choosing between what you want now and what you want most."

"A year from now you'll wish you started today."

"It's not about having time. It's about making time."

"Small daily improvements are the key to staggering long-term results."

"The only bad workout is the one that didn't happen."

YOUR TURN

Write your own mantra below. What will you tell yourself on the hard days? Make it personal. Make it powerful.

YOUR RECOMP ROADMAP.

Everything in this guide boils down to these core principles. Nail these consistently and results are inevitable.

01

EAT ENOUGH PROTEIN

1.6-2.2g per kg bodyweight. Every single day. This is the foundation.

02

TRAIN WITH INTENSITY

4x per week. Compound lifts. Progressive overload. Track everything.

03

MANAGE YOUR CALORIES

Slight deficit or maintenance. Never starve. Fuel performance.

04

PRIORITISE RECOVERY

7-9 hours sleep. Manage stress. Rest days matter.

05

STAY CONSISTENT

8-12 weeks minimum. No program hopping. Trust the process.

06

TRACK & ADJUST

Photos, measurements, strength. Use data, not feelings.

"Simple works. Consistent wins. Start today."

READY TO TRANSFORM?

This guide gave you the blueprint.
But if you want personalised coaching, accountability,
and a plan built specifically for YOUR body and goals...

WHAT YOU GET WITH 1:1 COACHING

- ✓ Custom training program built for your schedule and goals
- ✓ Personalised nutrition plan (no cookie-cutter macros)
 - ✓ Weekly check-ins and form reviews
- ✓ Direct messaging access for questions anytime
- ✓ Progressive adjustments based on YOUR data
- ✓ Mindset coaching and accountability

APPLY FOR COACHING

Limited spots available each month.
Serious applicants only.

GET IN TOUCH

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THANK YOU.

You now have everything you need to start your body recomposition journey. No more excuses, no more confusion. Just action.

Remember: consistency beats perfection.
Start today. Not Monday. Today.

STAY CONNECTED

Follow for daily tips, training content,
and free resources:

@aaronrichardson

www.aaronrichardson.com

"The best time to start was yesterday.
The next best time is now."

BODY RECOMPOSITION BLUEPRINT

BY AARON RICHARDSON